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F

FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

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F 14723

1949

CHINA

Registry Number F14720/10127/10

FROM Foreign Office minute (Mr. Coates).

No.

Dated 21 Sep 1949

Received in Registry 29 Sep 1949

F: China

Enquiry by two Communists whether H.M. Government still consider themselves bound by the provisions of the Yalta Agreement regarding Formosa.

It is suggested that News Department might use the Far Eastern Department memorandum of 8th February on Formosa (F2120/10127/10) in their reply.

Last Paper

F14590

References

See minutes (Minutes)

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed)

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News Dept. have been asked by two Communists whether H.M.G. still consider themselves bound by the provisions of the Yalta Agreement (sic) regarding Formosa. Quite what lies behind this is not yet apparent, but the query is evidently not an innocent one. It is also rather a tricky one to parry.

I suggest tentatively that News Dept. might use paras. 1, 2 and 3 of the F.E. Dept. memorandum of the 8th. February 1949 about Formosa to explain that although the final disposition of Formosa must await the signature of a Treaty of Peace with Japan or some instrument with similar effect the Chinese have in practice exercised control of Formosa since the end of the war and therefore in practice the Cairo Declaration, as reinforced by the Potsdam Declaration, has already been implemented in respect of Formosa.

P.D.Coates.
21st. September.

Nothing to be Written in this Margin.

Mr. Riches
News Dept.
(Mr. Matthews)

Yes - I think this is the best we can do.

21/9

Mr. Tomlinson
with the m/ce.
Sld.

See O.N.

Mr. Tomlinson
O.N.

Mr. Tomlinson
Pink Sheet
F Dept 3/10
5/11